

Florian Strauf

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SUMMARY

Former SAP Solution Architect and technology leader with 20+ years of experience across customer advisory, presales, solution architecture, and hands-on product building. I help translate business priorities into practical technology decisions, particularly where AI, automation, data, and custom software intersect. My background combines deep SAP and enterprise experience with recent hands-on work building and operating AI-enabled products and workflows, giving me both strategic and practical credibility. I have worked across executive advisory, build-vs-buy evaluation, GTM support, architecture planning, and the development of business cases for emerging technologies.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- **AI Strategy, Use Case Discovery & Business Alignment:** Strong track record of translating business requirements into pragmatic AI, automation, and technology priorities.
- **Build-vs-Buy Evaluation & Solution Architecture:** Experience assessing packaged platforms versus custom development and aligning decisions with operational needs.
- **Customer Advisory & Executive Communication:** Credible with leadership teams, business stakeholders, and delivery teams when turning complex technical topics into clear decisions.
- **Workflow Automation, Data & AI Implementation:** Able to connect automation, data platforms, and AI opportunities to concrete business outcomes and practical rollout paths.
- **GTM Support, Thought Leadership & Innovation Programs:** Experience supporting go-to-market efforts, innovation initiatives, and customer-facing solution development.
- **Technical Leadership & Delivery Enablement:** Proven ability to lead teams, improve development processes, and raise execution quality without losing speed.
- **Hands-On Technical Depth:** Credible across architecture and implementation, from enterprise integrations and backend systems to frontend applications, data pipelines, and analytics.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder, LearnedLate

Independent Advisor & Builder | March 2025 - Present

Building a consulting practice focused on practical AI strategy, workflow automation, and custom software for businesses that need a clearer starting point, a better process, or a custom build when packaged tools are not enough.

Relevant Work:

- Designed and operated an internal SEO workflow that automates keyword research, content generation, publishing, and iteration across owned sites, contributing to 200k+ search impressions with \$0 ad spend.
- Use this system as a live environment for testing AI-enabled workflows, content operations automation, and build-vs-buy decisions around standard tools versus custom software.
- Developed an advisory approach around AI opportunity assessment, workflow redesign, and implementation planning, grounded in hands-on system building rather than theory.

- Supported solution architecture work for New Zealand Packing and Kiwifruit Management Company, helping assess ERP direction, build-vs-buy tradeoffs, and where packaged platforms could be complemented by custom workflow and AI-enabled solutions.

Founder & Builder at daystoexpiry.com

2025 - Present

Built and operate a niche SaaS product from concept to paying customers. The platform demonstrates current, hands-on capability across product design, systems architecture, data processing, analytics, and AI-assisted workflows.

The application ingests and parses broker statements, normalizes positions and trades, and presents them in a clear, options-focused view. On top of this, I implemented AI-driven analysis to help users evaluate and plan options income strategies based on their actual portfolio holdings.

Key User Benefits Delivered:

- **Automated Data Pipeline:** Imports, scans, and reconciles broker statements into a clean, structured dataset.
- **AI-Assisted Trade Discovery:** Surfaces covered call, put-selling, and other income opportunities aligned with users' holdings.
- **Clear Performance Insight:** Visualizes income, risk, and drawdowns in an intuitive, portfolio-centric dashboard.
- **Actionable Strategy Guidance:** Bridges the gap from "what do I hold?" to "what should I do next?" with portfolio-aware suggestions.

CTO at Forgd.com

Jan 2024 - March 2025

Led the technical vision and delivery of Forgd.com, a platform serving blockchain builders, with responsibility spanning architecture, delivery, and team leadership.

Key Achievements:

- Built and scaled a robust platform from concept to over 1000 users in under 12 months.
- Grew and led a technical team from 4 to 14 developers while maintaining high-velocity.
- Implemented structured development processes with clear project phases and estimates.
- Architected and built complex data systems, including economic modeling algorithms in Python and big data integrations.

Founder & CEO at Tokenomics DAO (acquired by Forgd.com)

2021 - 2024

Founded and led a consulting-led community business focused on tokenomics and strategic design for web3 projects.

Key Achievements:

- Built a community of 3,000+ members.
- Scaled a consulting business to 10+ contributors serving 15+ clients.
- Developed a industry focused token launch SaaS for modelling supply demand curves of token launches
- Successfully merged the business with Forgd.com.

Solution Architect at SAP

2014 - 2021

Progressed through multiple roles at SAP across innovation, presales, and solution architecture, from Senior Consultant in Innovation to Solution Architect for Asset Intensive Industries and Innovation Centre Network Public Blockchain. Delivered complex enterprise solutions across multiple industries while shaping GTM, customer advisory, and board-level innovation initiatives.

Key Achievements:

- **Global Ports & Critical Infrastructure:** Led and supported solution architecture for major port authorities and terminal operators, including APM Terminals, Port of Rotterdam, Port of Hamburg, and Port of Singapore. Worked on TOS modernisation, container planning and loading optimisation, and end-to-end port digitalisation initiatives across IoT, maps, and data-driven decision support.
- **Blockchain & Innovation Leadership (2021):** Shaped SAP's strategy for emerging decentralized and AI-adjacent technologies, developing board-level proposals on crypto payments, token-based revenue models, and how new technologies could extend SAP's portfolio. Built business cases around new solution areas, translated complex technical concepts into executive decision material, and led supply chain carbon use cases across the German automotive industry, including SAP's engagement in Catena-X and Gaia-X.
- **Asset Intensive Industries (2020-2021):** Served as Solution Architect in the SAP Centre of Excellence for Asset Intensive Industries, connecting customer requirements to solution architecture, roadmap planning, and product extension strategy. Supported GTM planning as subject matter expert for Intelligent Asset Management (IAM), helping position solutions against industry needs and adoption opportunities.
- **Innovative Business Solutions (2018-2020):** Led solution architecture for IBSO proposals, translating customer challenges into solution options, business value narratives, and practical delivery approaches. Developed GTM approaches for new markets and products, supported presales engagements, and presented innovation topics at industry events.
- **Applied Technology Innovation (2014-2018):** Led delivery teams across innovation projects, proof of concepts, and pilots moving into productive use. Provided technical sales support for intelligent asset management offerings, owned IoT service areas, and worked across maps, connected asset, and data-driven use cases to turn new technologies into deployable customer solutions.
- **Delivery Excellence:** Successfully led cloud customers out of escalation by analyzing and improving system performance. Safeguarded innovation projects as trusted advisor.
- **Recognition:** SAP Catalyst / Fast Track awards: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019.

Development Consultant at SER Solutions Deutschland GmbH

2005 - 2014

Progressed from apprentice to Development Consultant, specializing in SAP ABAP development, workflow architecture, and enterprise content management integrations.

Key Achievements:

- **SAP FI/MM Invoice Processing (2012-2014):** Architected and developed FI/MM Invoice processing workflow solutions. Delivered UX development with SAP Fiori, SAPUI5, and OData services. Built Web Dynpro ABAP and NetWeaver Portal solutions. Developed ABAP Object-Oriented solutions and SAP Business Workflow implementations.
- **Product Management / Quality Management (2008-2012):** Led internal consulting projects on J2EE application servers (JBoss, IBM WebSphere). Managed migration of existing customers to latest product generation.
- **Apprenticeship (2005-2008):** Completed apprenticeship as Development Consultant with project development across .NET, Java, and Visual Basic.

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.)**, FOM University of Applied Sciences for Economics and Management, Köln/Bonn, Germany (2014)
- **Apprenticeship as Development Consultant**, IHK Germany (2008)

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Writing**: Over 2,300 readers follow my writing at [LearnedLate](#).